BEFORE YOU START

Workbook 3: How to use it

This is one of four workbooks that cover the middle of the course.

Your gifts How you've been designed - your strengths, according to you and others.

The space of your life Mapping your story, and what has happened in each season of it.

Expressing your calling Narrowing it to a sentence, then opening it back up. **This workbook**

Your growth plan Turning all of it into something you will actually do.

THREE THINGS WORTH REMEMBERING

This is not a test. Nobody marks it and nobody else reads it unless you choose to show them. An honest half-answer is worth more than a tidy one.

It is meant to be unhurried. Three or four sittings of half an hour is better than one long evening. The thinking needs time to settle.

You are not meant to do it alone. There are conversations with your coach built into each booklet. They matter more than any single page in it.

WHAT YOUR COACH IS FOR

A coach is not a mentor handing down their own experience. Their job is to ask questions and let you find your own answers. If they start telling you what they would do, it is entirely fair to point that out.

You will need a pen, a Bible, and somewhere you're unlikely to be interrupted. Your 'gifts and talents' results may not be fully complete, as it can take a while to get others to provide their assessments of you - don't let that stop you making progress on this workbook.

HOW TO GET THE MOST FROM THE BIBLE READINGS

These devotional materials are designed to provide the New Testament backdrop to your ongoing consideration of what Christian work and calling is.

Read them slowly. Read them multiple times. Pray through them. Underline bits, meditate on them. Memorise them, and write down what you sense the Holy Spirit might be saying to you as you do all of the above. The Bible passages, by definition, are God speaking. Embrace His words, listen as attentively as you can. To keep this sustainable, we'd recommend you swap it out for your quiet times, rather than treating it as additional material.

SECTION THREE

Expressing your calling

First narrow everything you've learned about your calling so far down to a single sentence. Afterwards, we'll generate lots of different ideas about expressing it - the same calling could be lived out in far more ways than the two or three you may have already thought of.

Do not skip the second half. People can arrive at this section with one idea already in mind; the point of the lenses is to find out whether it survives contact with the alternatives.

Read these passages first

Matthew 28:18-20	The commission that sits over every calling.
Matthew 22:34-40	The two commandments everything else hangs on.
1 Corinthians 15:58	Your labour is not in vain.
Acts 18:1–4	Paul the tentmaker *and* preacher.
Psalm 37, especially v3–7	Patient trust in God's timing.

> Your general calling is the great commission and the greatest commandments, and it is the same as every other Christian's. Your specific calling works inside that — it is about where and how, not whether.

READING 1 OF 3

Acts 4:13

Ordinary, and unmistakably His

Even if we are seen as 'common and uneducated', with very little talent, we can make a massive difference for the kingdom if we have 'been with Jesus'. Read 3:1-4:22 - Peter and John knew Jesus, had been filled with His Spirit, had spent time in His presence. This allowed them to exercise faith, see incredible healing, lead thousands to Jesus, and engage the highest-ranking people in society. In the world's eyes they had very little talent, but when combined with being in Jesus' presence, everything changed.

> *"I thank God for my handicaps for, through them, I have found myself, my work, and my God"* — Helen Keller

QUESTIONS TO CONSIDER

write your answers below

— What limitations and constraints affect you most?

— Where has your relationship with Jesus, and time spent with Him, given you an ability to overcome your limitations for His glory?

— How have your limitations and constraints revealed, shaped and focused the things you feel you may be called into?

SUGGESTED PRAYER POINTS

journal your prayers below, and any answers or prompting you receive

— Worship! He is infinite, all-sufficient, omnipotent, eternal - unlike us, He has no limitations

— Confessing where you have allowed your limitations to make you bitter toward God, or tried to operate beyond your own limitations in your own strength, not His

— Asking for the Holy Spirit to help you meet with Jesus, to 'be with' Him

SECTION THREE · STEP ONE

Everything you have found so far

Before you write anything new, bring together everything you already have. Read it as one picture: what keeps showing up is the clue.

From your assessment: your strongest gifts and biggest weaknesses

Strengths identified in you, especially by others

When you are most energised

The threads you noticed, combining the ‘open doors’, ‘hardship and loss’, ‘people’, ‘lasting fruit’ and ‘God’s leading’ categories

SECTION THREE · STEP TWO

Narrow it to a sentence

Build it in three parts, in your own words. Nothing here is final.

God seems to have designed me to...

[What you do - the kind of contribution you make]

among...

[Who it's for - the people or place it's aimed at],

so that...

[What it brings about]

Now write it in your own words

This is the sentence you will keep coming back to, so make it sound like you rather than like a mission statement.

Why does this matter to God?

When you do this well, how does it give Him glory, extend His kingdom, or bring beauty, order or abundance?

READING 2 OF 3

Matthew 6:19-34

Treasure, and what you seek first

How we use our talents is hugely impacted by our motivations. We could choose to use them for our own ends, to serve money (or some other earthly reward) rather than God. But ultimately the gospel compels us to be motivated to 'seek first the kingdom', and to expend ourselves 'laying up treasure in heaven', rather than obsessing about food, clothing, possessions or other material wealth.

> *"The only 'Christian work' is good work, well done."*
>
> — Dorothy L. Sayers, Why Work?

QUESTIONS TO CONSIDER

write your answers below

— In what areas of your life are you most tempted to follow 'money' (or some other man-made idol) rather than God?

— What does 'seeking first the kingdom and His righteousness' look like in your life currently? What might it look like going forward?

SUGGESTED PRAYER POINTS

journal your prayers below, and any answers or prompting you receive

— Worship - thanking the Father for knowing what our daily needs are, and providing them, like verses 25-32 remind us

— Confessing any areas of your life where you've not been 'seeking first the kingdom'

— Asking for the Holy Spirit to help you overcome any anxiety about the future

SECTION THREE · STEP THREE

How many ways could this play out?

Each lens below is a different angle on *'what could this actually look like in practice?'* Use these as prompts to populate the 'Your Ideas' sheet below.

HOW THIS WORKS

Quantity, not quality. You are looking for a volume and breadth of ideas, not 'the right answer'. Aim for 15+ ideas across the six lenses.

Do not judge any of these yet. Impractical ideas are helping your thinking. You will narrow these down afterwards in a separate exercise.

One line each. If you dry up, change lenses rather than pushing harder at the same one.

Lens 1. Who it serves

Take the 'calling sentence' you wrote above, and picture it aimed at a different group of people.

Expressed toward the obvious group — and then toward the group nobody is serving.
Expressed toward the person you used to be, ten years ago.
Expressed toward the people you would find hardest to serve.
Expressed toward an age group you have never considered.

Lens 2. Where it happens

Take the 'calling sentence' you wrote above, and picture it lived out in a completely different setting.

Expressed inside a sector you know nothing about.
Expressed somewhere with no money, staff or infrastructure.
Expressed in a place where this is currently done badly.
Expressed in a school. A prison. A hospital. A pub.

Lens 3. How you do it

Take the 'calling sentence' you wrote above, and imagine playing a different role in expressing it.

Expressed by teaching others to do it, rather than doing it.
Expressed by building the tool or system that lets others do it.
Expressed by funding or resourcing people already doing it.
Expressed in writing or speaking rather than in practice.
Expressed by convening the people already doing it.

The remaining lenses

Lens 4. How big it is

Take the 'calling sentence' you wrote above, and picture it aimed at wildly different sizes.

Expressed for exactly one person, done brilliantly.
Expressed for a room of twelve.
Expressed at the level of a whole organisation.
Expressed across an entire profession or field.
Expressed in a single Saturday — and then across a decade.

Lens 5. What carries it

Take the 'calling sentence' you wrote above, and picture it within a different structure: a job, a business, a volunteer role, a church.

Expressed as your actual paid job.
Expressed as a business someone would pay for.
Expressed voluntarily, alongside a job that pays the bills.
Expressed through your local church.
Expressed by joining something that already exists.

Lens 6. What if...?

Take the 'calling sentence' you wrote above, and challenge your own assumptions about what this has to look like.

What if you had ten years and no money worries?
What if you could only give it two days a week?
What if the thing you are worst at were required?
What if you had to hand it to someone else in three years?
What if nobody ever knew it was you?
What would the boldest person you know do with your sentence?

> If you are stuck, take two lenses at random and force them together. Odd pairings produce the ideas single prompts never do.

SECTION THREE · STEP THREE

Your ideas

One line each. Write the lens number in the margin if it helps. When you have finished, go back and mark the ones with something in them.

1 ☆

2 ☆

3 ☆

4 ☆

5 ☆

6 ☆

7 ☆

8 ☆

9 ☆

10 ☆

11 ☆

12 ☆

13 ☆

14 ☆

15 ☆

16 ☆

17 ☆

18 ☆

19 ☆

20 ☆

Before you move on, check: is there a lens you avoided? The one you skipped could surprise you. Go back and give it two minutes.

SECTION THREE · STEP FOUR

Turn the best into expressions

Now bring the ideas together. An expression is a fuller picture than a one-liner — a short paragraph describing what that version of your calling would actually be. You might cover what you'd be doing, where you'd be doing it, how that would glorify God, how the bills would get paid, what a normal week might look like, the kind of people you'd be working alongside and so on.

Write two or three potential 'expressions' of your calling, perhaps combining multiple of the ideas you starred above.

EXPRESSION ONE

Give it a short name

EXPRESSION TWO

Give it a short name

EXPRESSION THREE

Give it a short name

EXPRESSION FOUR

Give it a short name

READING 3 OF 3

1 Peter 4:8-11; 1 Corinthians 10:31

Gifts, to be spent on other people

'Each has received a gift - use it', 'steward God's varied grace', 'use it to serve one another' 'that in everything God may be glorified'. Peter's list of giftings is the shortest in the bible - can you speak, can you serve? His directions are equally concise - **use them in God's power, and use them for His glory.**

Paul backs this up in 1 Corinthians 10, and makes it even more general - **whatever** you're doing, whether it's something within your gifting or calling or not, you can, and should, do it for God's glory.

> *"I do not consecrate myself to be a missionary or a preacher. I consecrate myself to God to do His will where I am, be it in school, office, or kitchen, or wherever He may, in His wisdom, send me."*
>
> — Watchman Nee, The Normal Christian Life

QUESTIONS TO CONSIDER

write your answers below

— Do you consider doing the things you're good at as 'stewarding God's grace'? How does this change how you might think/feel/act?

— In what contexts do you find yourself having the opportunity to 'speak' at the moment? What about 'serving'?

— In practice, how can God be glorified in your 'speaking' / 'serving' / 'whatever you do'?

SUGGESTED PRAYER POINTS

journal your prayers below, and any answers or prompting you receive

— Worship Jesus - 'To Him belong glory and dominion forever and ever. Amen!'

— Confessing any times that come to mind where your work has resulted in your glory, not His

— Asking for the Holy Spirit to help you 'speak like an oracle of God' and 'serve with God's strength'

CONVERSATION THREE

Testing them

Take your sentence and your expressions to your coach before you build a plan around them. Give them this page.

FOR THE COACH · ABOUT 60 MINUTES

What this conversation is for

Pressure-testing the sentence, and making sure they have genuinely explored a range of different ways of expressing what they currently understand to be their calling before narrowing down options. Your job here is to widen the field, not to help them choose.

QUESTIONS TO ASK

"Read me the sentence. Does it sound like you, or like someone you think you should be?"

"Which of these ideas did you dismiss quickest, and why?"

"What would it cost you to pursue the one you starred?"

"Which of these could you start something toward within a month?"

WHAT TO LOOK OUT FOR

Statements that are all abstraction are hard to act on. Push gently for specificity.

Watch for a calling shaped entirely by what would impress others, or entirely by what feels safe.

AVOID Narrowing it for them. Your job is to widen the field and test the options, not to pick.

After the conversation — write down what, if anything, changed in your thinking: